



Terraform

OVERVIEW & FUNDAMENTALS

PAGE 1

What is Terraform?

Terraform is an Infrastructure as Code (IaC) tool by HashiCorp that allows you to define, provision and manage infrastructure using human-readable configuration files.

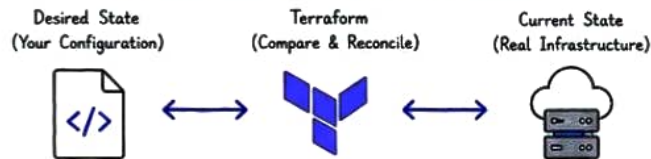
It helps you:

- ✓ Provision infrastructure consistently
- ✓ Multi-cloud and multi-provider support
- ✓ Version infrastructure
- ✓ Automate changes and deployments
- ✓ Manage complex dependencies

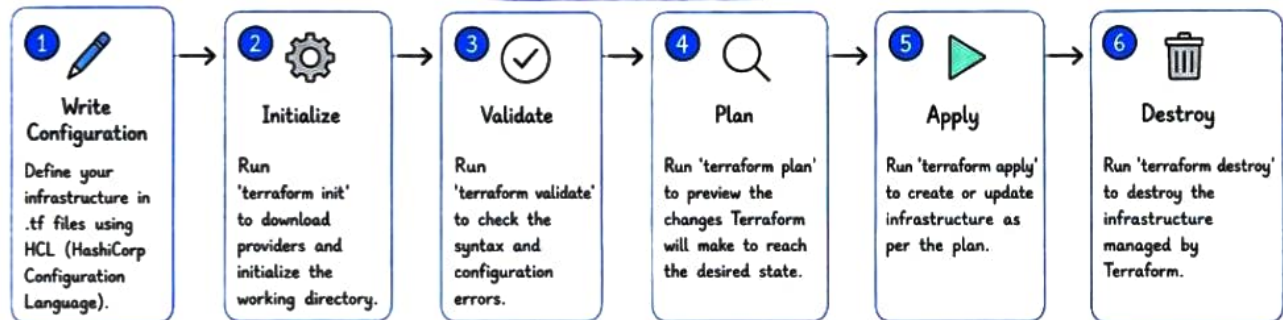
How Terraform Works



Terraform follows Desired State Model



Terraform Workflow



Frequently Used Commands

Command	Purpose	Command	Purpose
<code>>> terraform init</code>	Initialize a working directory	<code>>> terraform output</code>	Show output values
<code>>> terraform validate</code>	Validate the configuration files	<code>>> terraform state list</code>	List resources in the state
<code>>> terraform fmt</code>	Format the configuration files	<code>>> terraform state rm</code>	Remove a resource from state
<code>>> terraform plan</code>	Show the execution plan	<code>>> terraform import</code>	Import existing infrastructure
<code>>> terraform apply</code>	Apply the changes	<code>>> terraform workspace list</code>	List all workspaces
<code>>> terraform destroy</code>	Destroy the infrastructure	<code>>> terraform workspace new <name></code>	Create a new workspace
<code>>> terraform show</code>	Show the current state or a plan	<code>>> terraform workspace select <name></code>	Switch to a workspace

Example Configuration (AWS EC2)

```
provider "aws" {
  region = "us-east-1"
}

resource "aws_instance" "web" {
  ami           = "ami-0abcdef1234567890"
  instance_type = "t2.micro"
  tags = {
    Name = "Terraform-EC2"
  }
}

output "public_ip" {
  value = aws_instance.web.public_ip
}
```



Uses of Terraform

- Infrastructure Provisioning**
Automate the creation of infrastructure.
- Multi-Cloud Management**
Manage resources across multiple cloud providers.
- Consistency & Reusability**
Use code to maintain consistent environments.
- Collaboration**
Enable teams to work together using version control.
- CI/CD Integration**
Integrate with CI/CD pipelines for automation.
- Disaster Recovery**
Recreate infrastructure quickly when needed.



- ✓ Terraform is an IaC tool to manage infrastructure.
- ✓ It uses configuration files to define the desired state.
- ✓ It compares the desired state with the current state and makes necessary changes.
- ✓ It supports multi-cloud, automation, collaboration and versioning.



Terraform

STATE MANAGEMENT & DIFFERENCES

PAGE 2

Terraform State File

The state file keeps track of the infrastructure managed by Terraform.



Stores:

- Resource IDs
- Resource Attributes
- Dependencies
- Metadata
- Current Infrastructure State

Terraform compares



Configuration
(Desired State)



State File
(Current State)



Real Infrastructure
(Actual State)

Local vs Remote State

Local State



terraform.tfstate

Stored on your local machine.

Cons:

- ✗ Not suitable for teams
- ✗ No state locking
- ✗ Risk of state loss
- ✗ No backup/versioning

Remote State



Stored in a remote backend (S3, Azure Blob, GCS or Terraform Cloud).

Benefits:

- ✓ Team Collaboration
- ✓ State Locking
- ✓ Versioning & Backup
- ✓ High Availability
- ✓ Better Security

Remote State Backends (Examples)



AWS S3
(with DynamoDB
for locking)



Microsoft Azure
Storage Account
(with Blob)



Google Cloud
Storage



Terraform Cloud
(Managed Backend)



Other Options
Consul, etcd, etc.

State File Corruption - Causes



- Manual editing of state file
- Interrupted "terraform apply"
- Simultaneous execution without locking
- Accidental deletion of state file
- Backend/storage issues

State File Corruption - Recovery Steps

- 1 Restore from backend versioning/backup (if available).
- 2 If infrastructure still exists, re-import using "terraform import".
- 3 Rebuild state using "terraform state" commands if needed.
- 4 Run "terraform plan" to verify the recovered state.



Workspaces

Workspaces allow you to manage multiple isolated state files within the same configuration.



Each workspace has its own state file.

Useful For:

- ✓ Environments (Dev, QA, Prod)
- ✓ Separate Teams
- ✓ Isolated Deployments

Common Commands

- > terraform workspace list # List all workspaces
- > terraform workspace new <name> # Create new workspace
- > terraform workspace select <name> # Switch workspace
- > terraform workspace delete <name> # Delete workspace

Terraform State Commands

Command	Purpose
<code>> terraform state list</code>	List all resources in the state
<code>> terraform state show <addr></code>	Show details of a resource
<code>> terraform state rm <addr></code>	Remove resource from state
<code>> terraform import <addr> <id></code>	Import existing resource
<code>> terraform state mv <a> </code>	Move resource in state
<code>> terraform refresh</code>	Refresh state with real infra (legacy, use plan/apply now)

Key Takeaways



- ✓ State file is the heart of Terraform.
- ✓ Always use a remote backend for team and production environments.
- ✓ Enable state locking and versioning to prevent corruption and data loss.
- ✓ Workspaces help you maintain separate environments with isolated states.
- ✓ Regular backups of the state file are critical for disaster recovery.



Best Practice

Never edit state file manually.
Always use Terraform commands!



Terraform

PAGE 3

INTERVIEW QUESTIONS & REAL-TIME SCENARIOS

1 What happens if the Terraform state file is deleted?



- Terraform loses track of the infrastructure.
- Resources may still exist, but Terraform no longer manages them.

Recovery:

- Restore state from backend/backup.
- If no backup, re-import existing resources using "terraform import".

2 Using workspaces, if the state file is deleted, how do you recover?



- Select the correct workspace.
- If using remote backend, restore the state from versioning/backup.
- If no backup, re-import existing resources.

```
terraform workspace select prod
terraform plan
terraform import <resource> <id>
terraform apply
```

3 What if the state file is corrupted?



- Restore from backup or backend versioning.
- Validate the state.
- Run "terraform plan" to check for drift.
- Re-import resources if required.

4 How do you prevent state corruption?



- Use a remote backend.
- Enable state locking (e.g., DynamoDB with S3).
- Enable versioning on backend storage.
- Never edit state file manually.
- Restrict write access to the state.

5 Difference between Local State and Remote State?

	Local State	Remote State
Storage	Stored on local machine	Stored in remote backend
Team Usage	Not suitable for teams	Suitable for teams
State Locking	No locking	Supports locking
Versioning	No versioning	Versioning available
Risk	High risk of loss	Low risk (backup & versioning available)

6 What is "terraform import"?



Imports existing infrastructure into Terraform state without recreating resources.

```
terraform import aws_instance.web i-1234567890abcdef0
```

7 What is State Locking?



State locking prevents multiple users from modifying the state simultaneously, avoiding conflicts and corruption.

8 What are Terraform Modules?



Modules are reusable collections of Terraform configurations. They help in code reusability, standardization and easier management.

Example:

```
modules/
├── network/
├── compute/
└── database/
```

9 Difference between "terraform plan" and "terraform apply"?



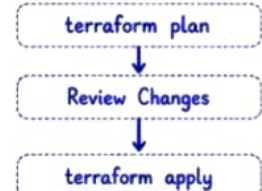
- "terraform plan": Shows the changes Terraform will make (preview).
- "terraform apply": Executes the changes and updates the infrastructure.

10 Real-Time Scenario: Your laptop crashed while running "terraform apply". What would you do?



- 1 Check if the state was updated.
- 2 Verify the actual cloud resources.
- 3 Restore the state from backend/backup if needed.
- 4 Run "terraform plan" to identify any differences.
- 5 If resources exist but missing from state, use "terraform import".
- 6 Run "terraform apply" again after confirming the plan.

Commands Flow



Best Practices

- ✓ Always use a remote backend.
- ✓ Enable state locking and versioning.
- ✓ Never modify state file manually.
- ✓ Use workspaces for environment isolation.
- ✓ Regularly backup your state files.
- ✓ Review "terraform plan" before every apply.



Key Takeaways

- ✓ State file is the single source of truth for Terraform.
- ✓ Remote state ensures collaboration, safety and reliability.
- ✓ Workspaces help manage multiple isolated environments.
- ✓ Use import and state commands to recover infrastructure.
- ✓ Always follow best practices for secure and stable IaC.



Azure API Management (APIM) FUNDAMENTALS

PAGE 1

What is APIM?

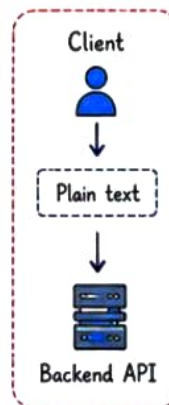
Azure API Management (APIM) is a fully managed Azure service that acts as a centralized gateway for APIs.

It helps organizations:

- ✓ Publish APIs
- ✓ Secure APIs
- ✓ Monitor API usage
- ✓ Transform requests/responses
- ✓ Manage API lifecycle
- ✓ Expose APIs to internal and external consumers

Why APIM?

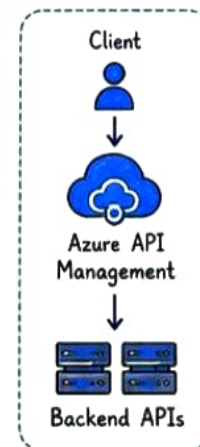
Without APIM:



Problems:

- ✗ No central security
- ✗ No throttling
- ✗ No monitoring
- ✗ Hard to manage multiple APIs

With APIM:



Benefits:

- ✓ Security
- ✓ Scalability
- ✓ Governance
- ✓ Monitoring
- ✓ API Reuse

APIM Core Components



Gateway

Main entry point for API requests.

Responsibilities:

- Authentication
- Authorization
- Routing
- Request validation
- Rate limiting



APIs

Collection of operations exposed through APIM.

Example:



Products

Logical grouping of APIs.

Example:



Developer Portal

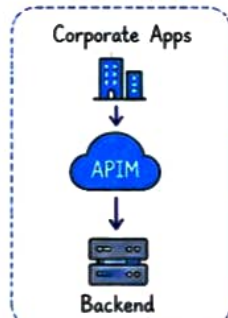
Self-service portal for developers.

Features:

- API documentation
- API testing
- Subscription management
- SDK downloads

APIM Deployment Modes

Internal Mode

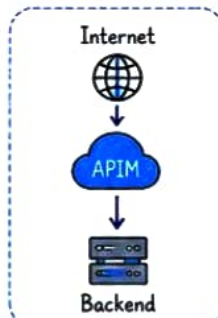


Only accessible inside VNET.

Used for:

- Enterprise APIs
- Internal Applications
- Microservices

External Mode

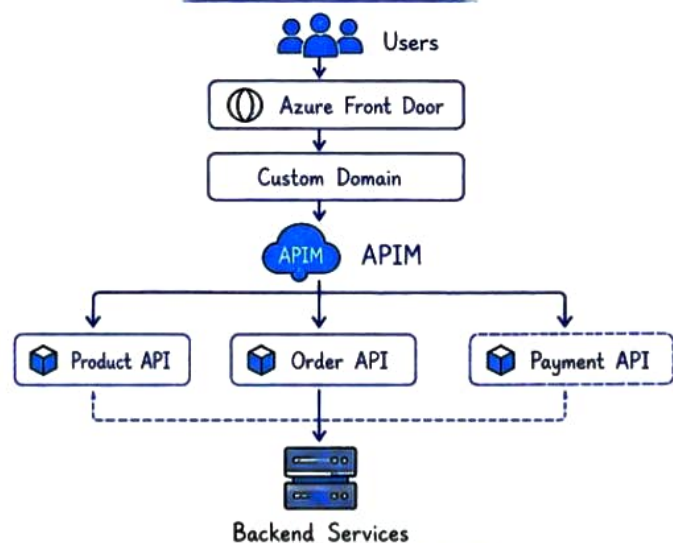


Publicly accessible.

Used for:

- Partner APIs
- Customer APIs
- Mobile Apps

APIM Architecture



- ✓ APIM is the front door for APIs
- ✓ Centralized API governance
- ✓ Supports internal and external APIs
- ✓ Simplifies security and monitoring
- ✓ Reduces backend exposure



APIM helps you build secure, scalable and well-governed APIs!



APIM Security

Authentication Methods

OAuth 2.0

Industry standard authentication.



JWT Validation

APIM validates JWT tokens before forwarding requests.

Policy:

XML

```
<validate-jwt>
...
</validate-jwt>
```

Benefits:

- ✓ Secure APIs
- ✓ Claims validation
- ✓ Role-based access

Named Values

Stores configuration securely.

Examples:

- Client ID
- Client Secret
- Backend URL
- API Keys
- Environment Variables

Instead of:

`https://prod.company.com`

Use:

`{{backend-url}}`

Managed Identity

APIM can access Azure services without storing secrets.

Example:



Benefits:

- ✓ No password storage
- ✓ Secure authentication
- ✓ Azure-native security

Subscription Keys

APIM generated key:

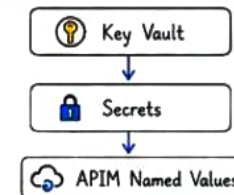
Ocp-Apim-Subscription-Key

Example:

HTTP GET /products

Ocp-Apim-Subscription-Key: xxxxx

APIM + Azure Key Vault

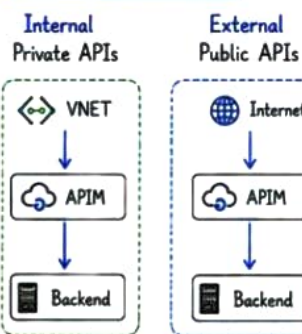


Store:

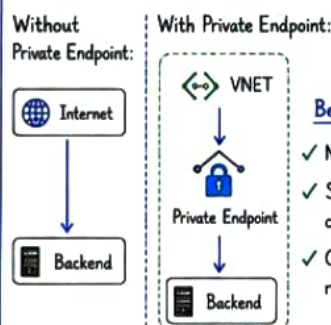
- Client Secret
- Certificates
- Connection Strings
- API Keys

Networking

Internal vs External



Private Endpoints

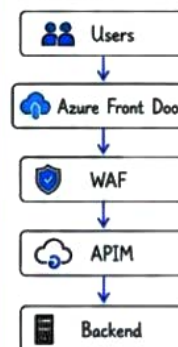


Benefits:

- ✓ No public exposure
- ✓ Secure communication
- ✓ Compliance requirements

APIM with Azure Front Door

Architecture:



Front Door Responsibilities:

- ✓ Global routing
- ✓ SSL termination
- ✓ WAF
- ✓ Load balancing
- ✓ DDoS protection

NAT Gateway

Used for:

- Static outbound IP
- Secure outbound traffic



APIM + Azure Functions



Benefits:

- ✓ Hide Function URL
- ✓ Secure Access
- ✓ Monitoring
- ✓ Policies

Security Best Practices

- ✓ Use OAuth 2.0
- ✓ Validate JWT
- ✓ Enable Private Endpoints
- ✓ Store secrets in Key Vault
- ✓ Use Managed Identity
- ✓ Use Front Door + WAF
- ✓ Enable IP Filtering

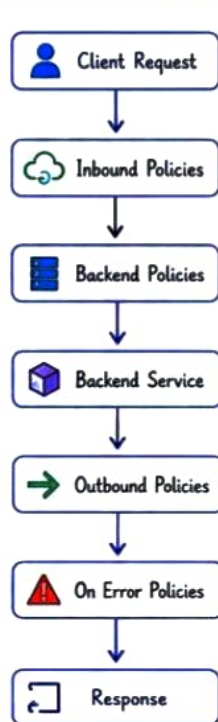


Azure API Management (APIM)

PAGE 3 – POLICIES, REQUEST FLOW, MONITORING & INTERVIEW QUESTIONS



APIM Policy Pipeline



Inbound Policies

Executed before backend call.

Examples:

- Validate JWT <validate-jwt>
- Rate Limiting <rate-limit-by-key>
- Rewrite URL <rewrite-uri>
- Check Headers <check-header>

Backend Policies

Executed before reaching backend.

Examples:

- Load balancing
- Backend switching
- Retry logic
- Circuit breaker

Outbound Policies

Executed after backend response.

Examples:

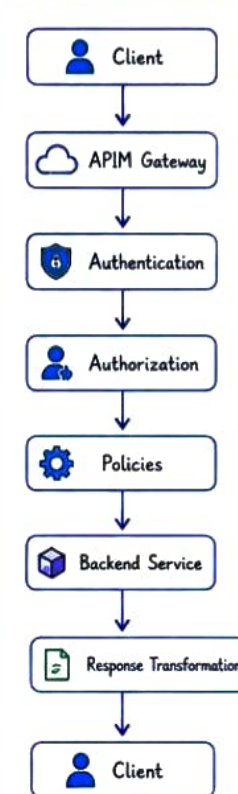
- Response transformation
- Header manipulation
- Data masking
- XML to JSON

Error Policies

Examples:

- Custom error messages
- Logging
- Retry
- Fallback response

Request Lifecycle



Monitoring & Analytics

Azure Monitor
Provides:

- ✓ Metrics
- ✓ Alerts
- ✓ Dashboards
- ✓ Health Monitoring

Application Insights
Tracks:

- ✓ Requests
- ✓ Dependencies
- ✓ Exceptions
- ✓ Performance
- ✓ Availability

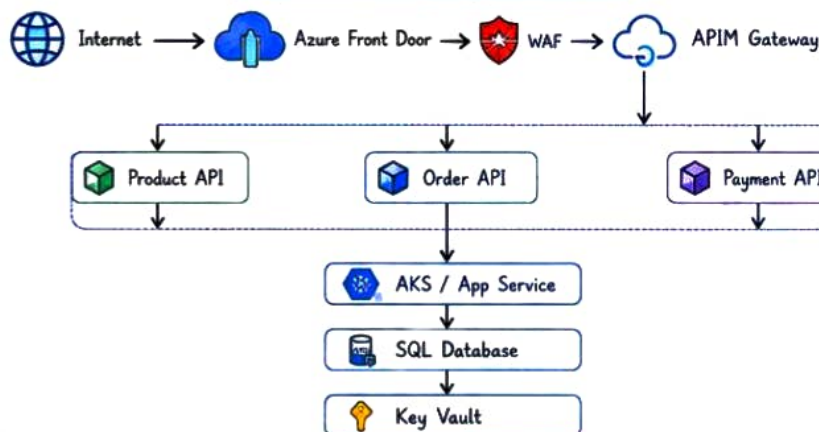
APIM Analytics
Shows:

- ✓ Top APIs
- ✓ Response Times
- ✓ Failure Rates
- ✓ Consumer Usage
- ✓ Subscription Metrics

Common HTTP Status Codes

Code	Meaning
200	Success
201	Created
204	No Content
400	Bad Request
401	Unauthorized
403	Forbidden
404	Not Found
409	Conflict
429	Too Many Requests
500	Internal Server Error
502	Bad Gateway
503	Service Unavailable
504	Gateway Timeout

Real Enterprise Architecture



APIM Interview Questions

Q1. What is APIM?

A centralized Azure service used to publish, secure, monitor and manage APIs.

Q2. What are Products?

Logical grouping of APIs exposed to consumers.

Q3. What are Policies?

Rules applied to requests and responses.

Examples:

- Authentication
- Rate Limiting
- Transformation
- Routing

Q4. What is Named Value?

Reusable configuration value stored in APIM.

Q5. Difference between Internal and External APIM?

Internal = Private access only.
External = Internet accessible.

Q6. Why use Front Door with APIM?

Provides WAF, global routing, SSL termination and DDoS protection before APIM.

Q7. What is Subscription Key?

Unique key used by consumers to access APIs.

Q8. What is the APIM Request Pipeline?

Inbound → Backend →
Outbound → Error Handling.



Final APIM Formula



TERRAFORM

SCENARIO BASED INTERVIEW QUESTIONS & ANSWERS

★ From Basic to Advanced ★

① What is Terraform?

Scenario: Explain Terraform to a beginner.

Answer / Solution:

- Terraform is an Infrastructure as Code (IaC) tool by HashiCorp.
- It helps to provision, manage and version infrastructure.
- It supports multiple cloud providers.



⑥ How do you handle secrets in Terraform?

Scenario: You need to store database password securely.

Answer / Solution:

- Use environment variables.
- Use terraform.tfvars (gitignored).
- Use secret management tools (AWS Secrets Manager, Azure Key Vault, HashiCorp Vault).



② Explain terraform workflow.

Scenario: How will you create infrastructure using Terraform?

Answer / Solution:

Write Code → terraform init → terraform plan
(Configuration) (Initialize) (Preview)
↳ terraform apply → terraform destroy
(Create Infra) (Destroy Infra)



⑦ How do you manage multiple environments (Dev, QA, Prod)?

Scenario: You need separate environments with different configurations.

Answer / Solution:

- Use workspaces.
- Or use separate directories with different tfvars files.
- Use variables for environment-specific values.



③ What is the difference between terraform plan and terraform apply?

Scenario: You want to preview changes before applying.

Answer / Solution:

- terraform plan → Shows the execution plan.
- terraform apply → Applies the changes to create/update resources.



⑧ How do you handle Terraform state?

Scenario: State file is important. How will you manage it?

Answer / Solution:

- Store state remotely (S3 + DynamoDB, Azure Storage, GCS).
- Enable state locking to prevent concurrent updates.
- Backup the state file regularly.



④ What is the purpose of terraform.tfstate file?

Scenario: Why is state file important?

Answer / Solution:

- It tracks the current state of infrastructure.
- Terraform uses it to map real resources.
- Never edit it manually.



⑨ How do you refactor Terraform code?

Scenario: Your Terraform code is big and hard to manage.

Answer / Solution:

- Use modules to break code into reusable components.
- Use variables and outputs properly.
- Follow DRY principle.



⑤ What are Terraform providers?

Scenario: How does Terraform interact with cloud platforms?

Answer / Solution:

- Providers are plugins that allow Terraform to interact with APIs of cloud platforms.
- Example: aws, azure, google, kubernetes.



⑩ How do you import existing infrastructure into Terraform?

Scenario: You have existing resources and want to manage using Terraform.

Answer / Solution:

- Use 'terraform import <resource_type.name> <resource_id>'
- Then run 'terraform plan' and 'terraform apply'.



IMPORTANT COMMANDS



- | | |
|----------------------|--------------------------------|
| • terraform init | - Initialize working directory |
| • terraform plan | - Show execution plan |
| • terraform apply | - Apply changes |
| • terraform destroy | - Destroy infrastructure |
| • terraform validate | - Validate configuration |
| • terraform fmt | - Format code |
| • terraform import | - Import existing resource |
| • terraform output | - Show output values |

BEST PRACTICES



- ✓ Write modular and reusable code
- ✓ Use remote state with locking
- ✓ Keep state file secure
- ✓ Use variable configuration values
- ✓ Follow naming conventions
- ✓ Review plan before apply
- ✓ Automate using CI/CD pipelines

COMMON TERRAFORM FILES



- | | |
|--------------------|---------------------------------|
| • main.tf | - Main configuration |
| • variables.tf | - Input variables |
| • outputs.tf | - Output values |
| • providers.tf | - Provider configuration |
| • terraform.tfvars | - Variable values |
| • versions.tf | - Terraform & provider versions |



EXAM TIP: Always understand the scenario, break it down, and write clean, modular, and maintainable Terraform code.



TERRAFORM with AZURE

Infrastructure as Code (IaC)

1. What is Terraform?

- Terraform is an open-source IaC tool by HashiCorp.
- It allows us to define and provision infrastructure across multiple cloud providers using code.
- For Azure, it uses Azure Provider to manage Azure resources.



Terraform

2. Why Terraform?

- ✓ Infrastructure as Code
- ✓ Version Controlled (Git)
- ✓ Repeatable & Consistent
- ✓ Eliminates Manual Errors
- ✓ Reusable Modules
- ✓ Multi-cloud Support
- ✓ Easy Integration with CI/CD

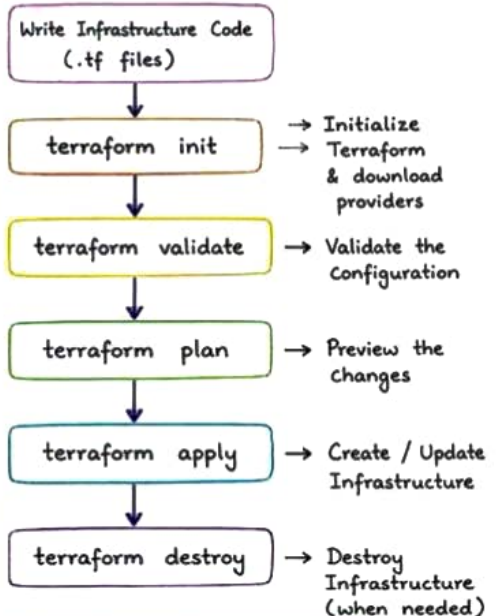
3. Azure Resources we can manage using Terraform

- Resource Groups
- Virtual Networks (VNet)
- Subnets
- Network Security Groups (NSG)
- Virtual Machines (Windows/Linux)
- Public IP Addresses
- Load Balancers
- Azure Storage Accounts
- Azure Key Vault
- Azure App Service
- Azure SQL Database
- Azure Kubernetes Service (AKS)
- Virtual Machine Scale Sets (VMSS)

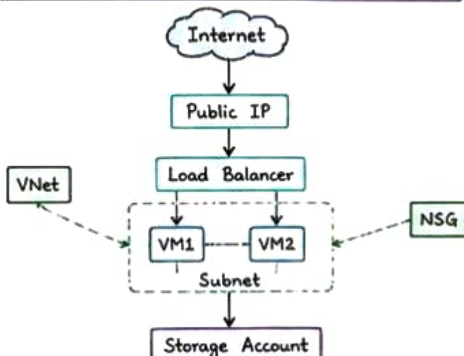
4. Core Terraform Concepts

- Providers - Define cloud platform
- Resources - The infrastructure
- Variables - Input values
- Outputs - Output values
- Modules - Reusable code
- State File - terraform.tfstate (Keeps track of resources)
- Backend - Remote storage for state file
- Data Sources - Fetch info from existing resources
- Workspaces - Multiple environments

5. Terraform Workflow



6. Example: Azure Infrastructure



7. Sample Terraform Structure

```

terraform-azure/
├── main.tf           # Main configuration
├── variables.tf      # Input variables
├── outputs.tf        # Output values
├── providers.tf      # Provider configuration
├── terraform.tfvars # Variable values
└── modules/          # Reusable modules
  
```

8. Benefits in Real World

- ♥ Automates Azure Infrastructure
- ♥ Saves Time & Effort
- ♥ Ensures Consistency
- ♥ Easy Rollback & Versioning
- ♥ Scalable & Production Ready
- ♥ Works Great with Azure DevOps and GitHub Actions

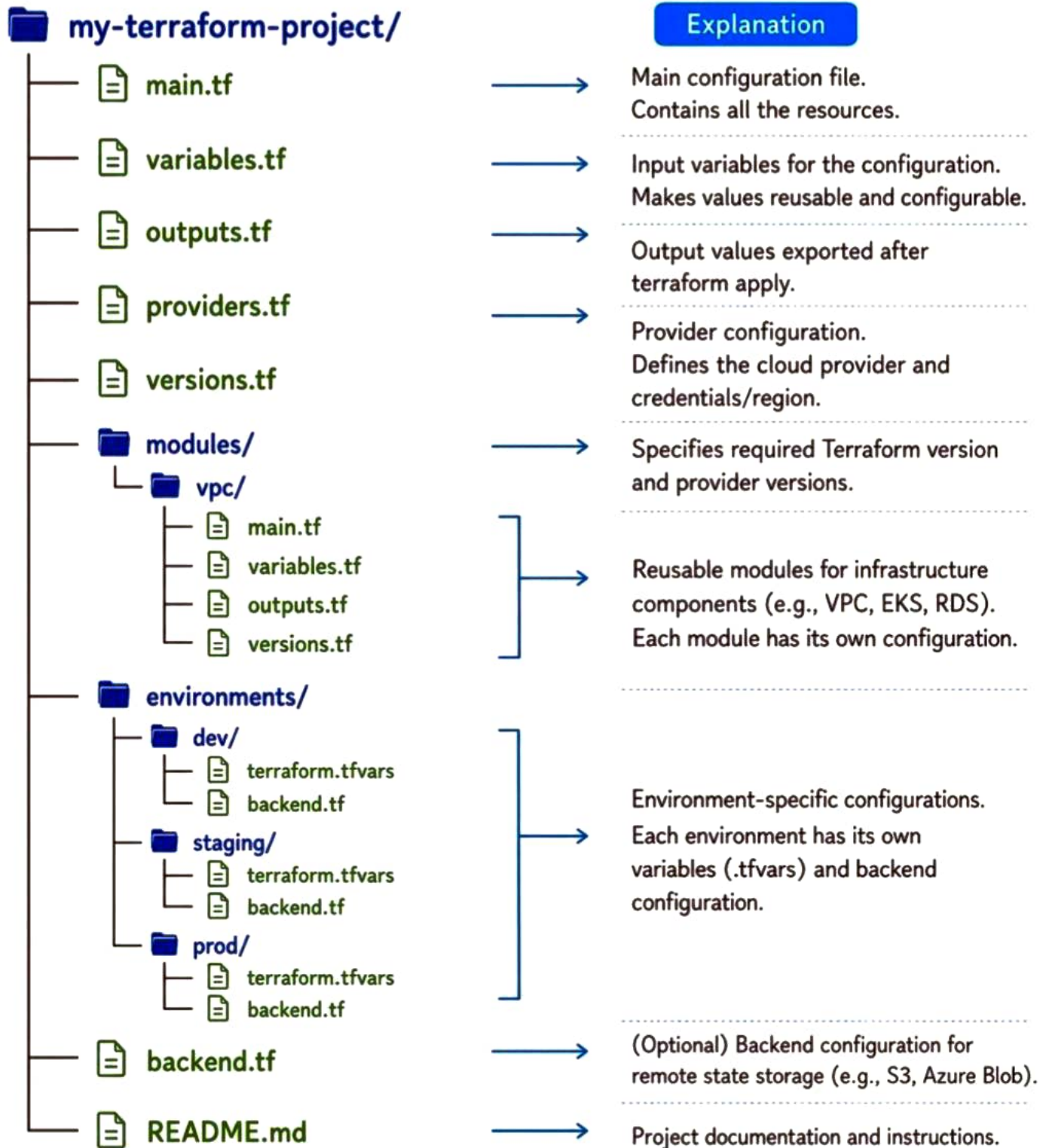
9. Common Azure Use Cases with Terraform

- | | | |
|--|----------------------------|---|
| ★ Deploy Networking (VNet, Subnets, NSG) | ★ Deploy AKS Clusters | ★ Create SQL Databases |
| ★ Provision Virtual Machines | ★ Manage Key Vaults | ★ Manage RBAC & IAM |
| ★ Create Storage Accounts | ★ Configure Load Balancers | ★ Build Complete Environments (Dev, Test, Prod) |
| | ★ Setup App Service | |

Note to Self

- Infrastructure as Code is not just about tools, it's about building a better way to manage cloud infrastructure.

Terraform Project Structure



COMPLETE NETWORKING (as per DevOps Engineer)

1. OSI Model (7 Layers)

- 7. Application - HTTP, FTP, SSH, DNS
- 6. Presentation - SSL/TLS, Encoding
- 5. Session - Session Mgmt, API
- 4. Transport - TCP, UDP
- 3. Network - IP, ICMP, Routing
- 2. Data Link - MAC, Switch, ARP
- 1. Physical - Cables, Hubs, Signals

2. IP Addressing

- IPv4 - 32 bit (Example: 192.168.1.1)
- IPv6 - 128 bit
- Public IP - Internet facing
- Private IP - Internal use (Not routable on internet)
 - 10.0.0.0 - 10.255.255.255
 - 172.16.0.0 - 172.31.255.255
 - 192.168.0.0 - 192.168.255.255
- Subnet Mask - Defines network & host
- CIDR Notation - 192.168.1.0/24

3. Important Protocols

- TCP (Transmission Control Protocol)
 - Connection Oriented, Reliable, Slow
 - Used by: HTTP, HTTPS, SSH, FTP
- UDP (User Datagram Protocol)
 - Connectionless, Fast, Unreliable
 - Used by: DNS, DHCP, Streaming
- ICMP (Internet Control Message Protocol)
 - Used for error reporting & diagnostics
 - Example: ping, traceroute
- DNS (Domain Name System)
 - Converts domain name to IP address
 - Uses UDP/TCP port 53
- DHCP (Dynamic Host Configuration Protocol)
 - Assigns IP address automatically
 - Uses UDP port 67 (server), 68 (client)
- HTTP/HTTPS - Web traffic (80/443)
- SSH - Secure Remote Access (22)
- FTP - File Transfer (20, 21)
- SMTP/IMAP/POP3 - Email (25, 143, 110)

4. Ports

Port	Protocol	Used For
20,21	TCP	FTP
22	TCP	SSH
53	UDP/TCP	DNS
80	TCP	HTTP
443	TCP	HTTPS
3306	TCP	MySQL
5432	TCP	PostgreSQL
6379	TCP	Redis

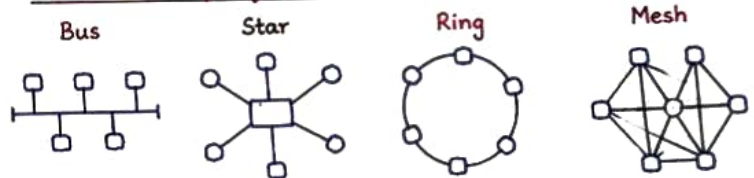
5. Networking Devices

- Hub - Broadcasts data to all ports (Layer 1)
- Switch - Sends data to specific port (Layer 2)
- Router - Forwards packets between networks (Layer 3)
- Firewall - Monitors & controls traffic
- Load Balancer - Distributes traffic across servers
- Gateway - Entry/Exit point of a network

6. Common Network Commands

- ip a / ifconfig - Check IP & interfaces
- ping <IP/Domain> - Check connectivity
- traceroute <IP> - Trace packet path
- nslookup <domain> - DNS lookup
- netstat -tulnp - Check open ports
- curl <url> - Test HTTP/HTTPS
- dig <domain> - DNS query
- arp -a - ARP table
- route -n - Routing table

7. Network Topologies



8. Cloud Networking (DevOps Perspective)

- VPC (Virtual Private Cloud) - Isolated cloud network
- Subnet - Divides VPC into smaller networks
 - Public Subnet - Has route to Internet Gateway
 - Private Subnet - No direct internet access
- Internet Gateway - Allows communication between VPC and Internet
- NAT Gateway - Allows outbound internet from private subnet
- Route Table - Controls traffic flow
- Security Group - Acts as virtual firewall (Stateful)
- Network ACL - Firewall at subnet level (Stateless)
- Peering - Connect two VPCs privately
- Load Balancer - Distributes incoming traffic

9. Important Concepts

- Latency - Time taken for data to travel
- Bandwidth - Amount of data transfer capacity
- Throughput - Actual data transfer rate
- Packet - Small unit of data in network
- MTU - Maximum Transmission Unit
- QoS - Quality of Service

10. Common Use in DevOps

- CI/CD tools communication (Jenkins, GitHub Actions)
- App deployment (Docker, Kubernetes)
- Monitoring & Logging (Prometheus, Grafana, ELK)
- Cloud Resources connectivity (AWS/Azure/GCP)
- Troubleshooting (ping, traceroute, logs)

★ Remember:

Good Networking knowledge is essential for Troubleshooting, Security & Performance in DevOps.

- By Abhishek Singh

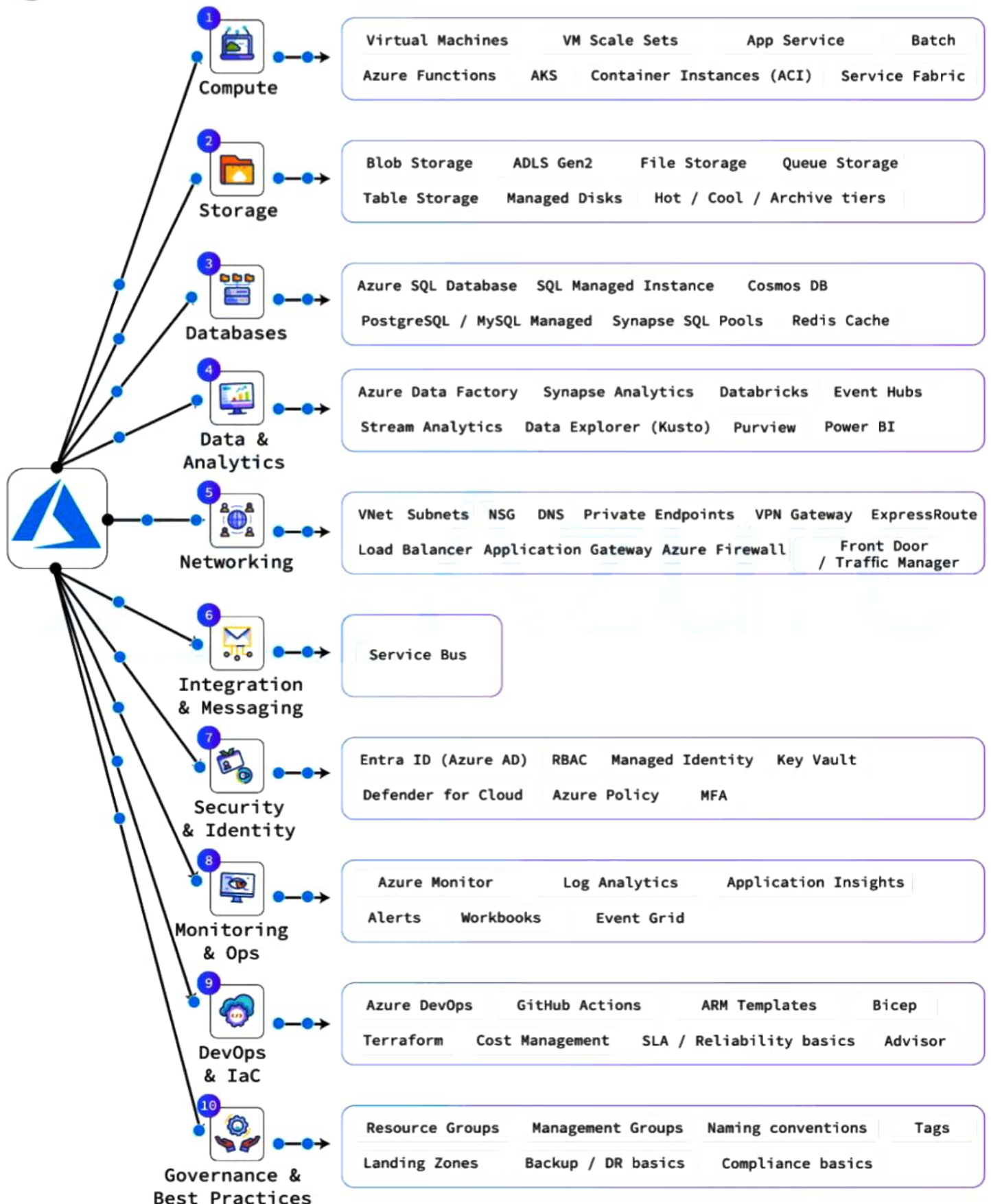
AZURE CLOUD MINDMAP

A practical guide for Data + Cloud Engineers



Aiswarya Venkitesh

DONT FORGET TO SAVE 📌





AZURE FRONT DOOR

Modern Layer 7 (Application) Load Balancer at Microsoft Global Edge.
Provides security, performance & intelligent routing.

VS

AZURE TRAFFIC MANAGER

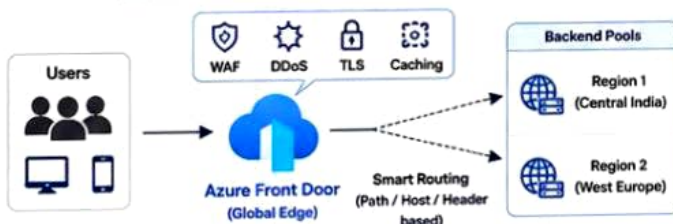
DNS-based Global Load Balancer.
Routes user traffic to the best or healthy endpoint using DNS responses.



FEATURE	AZURE FRONT DOOR	AZURE TRAFFIC MANAGER	KEY TAKEAWAYS
Service Type	Layer 7 (Application Layer)	Layer 3/4 (DNS Layer)	Use Azure Front Door
Routing	HTTP/HTTPS based routing (Path, Host, Header, Query String, etc.)	DNS based routing (Priority, Performance, Weighted, Geographic, Multi-value)	✓ For modern web apps & APIs
Global Presence	Uses Microsoft global edge network (Anycast) 200+ POPs worldwide	Uses DNS resolution Depends on DNS propagation (TTL)	✓ For security (WAF, DDoS, Bot Protection)
Performance	Low latency, Fast, Intelligent routing Traffic reaches Microsoft edge first	Relatively higher latency Depends on DNS resolution time	✓ For performance & low latency
Health Probing	Active health probes at the edge Very fast failure detection (~seconds)	Health probes from Traffic Manager Slower failover (TTL dependent, ~minutes)	✓ For advanced routing requirements
Protocols Supported	HTTP, HTTPS (Layer 7 features supported)	Any Protocol (TCP/UDP/HTTP/HTTPS) (Only DNS routing)	Use Azure Traffic Manager
Security	Built-in WAF, DDoS Protection, TLS Termination, Bot Protection, Rate Limiting	No WAF, No TLS Termination Basic DDoS Protection	✓ For non-HTTP services (TCP/UDP/SMTP etc.)
Caching	Yes - Global Caching (Static & Dynamic content)	No	✓ For simple DNS based routing
Use Cases	Web applications, APIs, SaaS, Microservices, Global secure apps	Non-HTTP services, Legacy apps, Simple DNS based routing	✓ For cost-effective global failover scenarios
Cost	Higher (Premium features)	Lower (Cost effective)	✓ For legacy applications
Best When	You need security, performance, intelligent routing and modern app delivery	You need simple, cost-effective, DNS based traffic distribution	

ARCHITECTURE COMPARISON

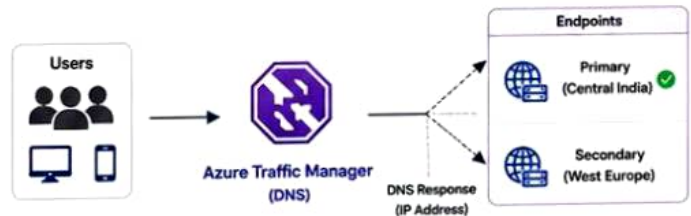
AZURE FRONT DOOR - LAYER 7 ROUTING (EDGE)



EXAMPLE:

If user requests `https://app.contoso.com/api`
→ Front Door checks rule (Path: /api)
→ Routes to API backend in Central India
If /web → Routes to Web backend in West Europe

AZURE TRAFFIC MANAGER - DNS ROUTING



EXAMPLE:

User requests `https://app.contoso.com`
→ Traffic Manager DNS returns IP of Healthy endpoint
→ If Central India is down, returns West Europe IP
→ User connects to West Europe

SUMMARY

Front Door

- ✓ Advanced routing (L7)
- ✓ Global edge network
- ✓ Security (WAF, DDoS, Bot Protection)
- ✓ Low latency & high performance
- ✓ Best for modern, secure web applications



Traffic Manager

- ✓ DNS based routing (L3/4)
- ✓ Simple & cost-effective
- ✓ Supports any protocol
- ✓ Slower failover (TTL based)
- ✓ Best for non-HTTP or legacy applications

QUICK EXAMPLE



You have a Banking Web App:

→ Use Front Door → for security, speed and intelligent routing.



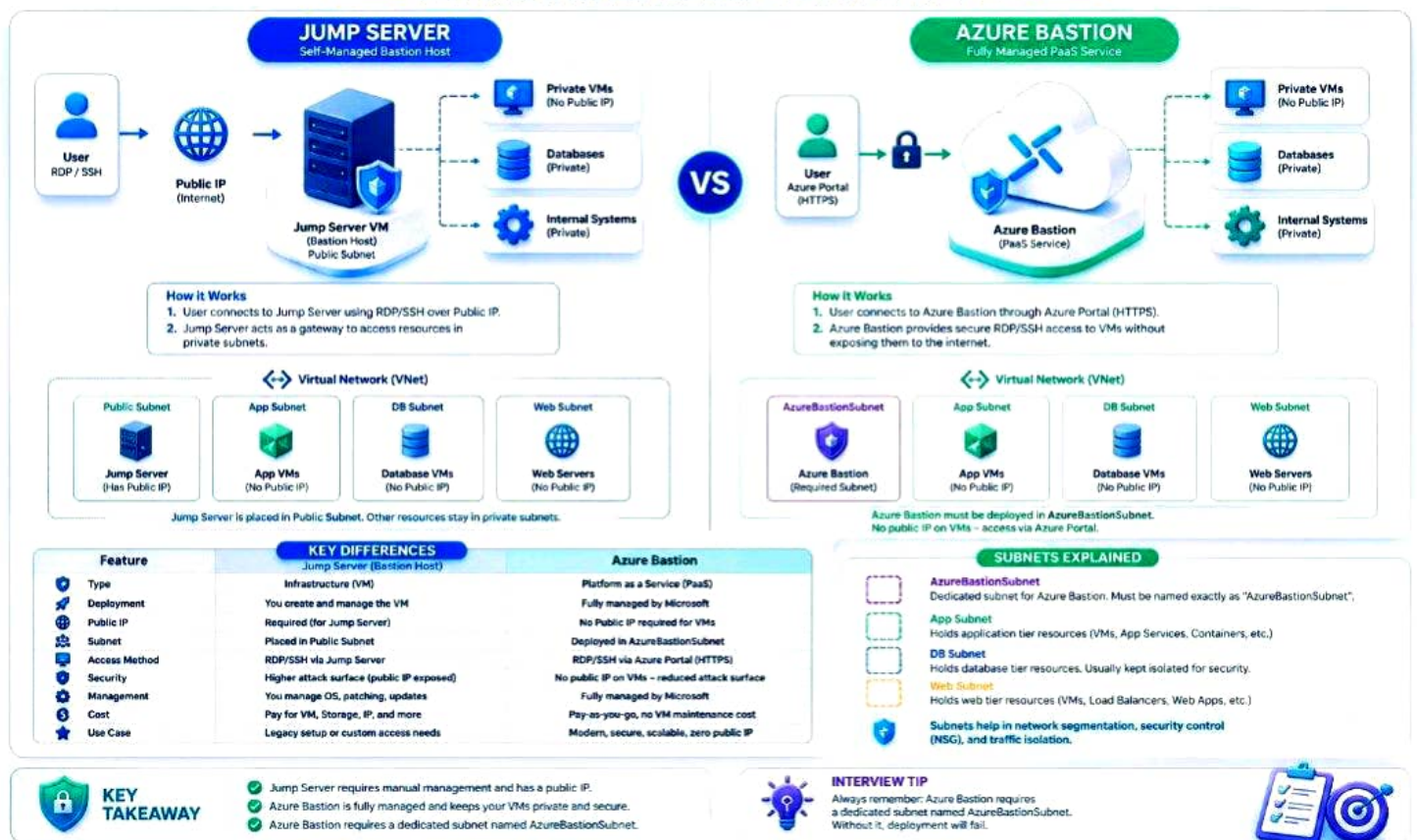
You have a Game Server (TCP):

→ Use Traffic Manager → for simple DNS based failover.

Front Door is a modern Layer 7 (Application) Load Balancer at Microsoft Global Edge. Traffic Manager is a DNS-based Global Load Balancer.

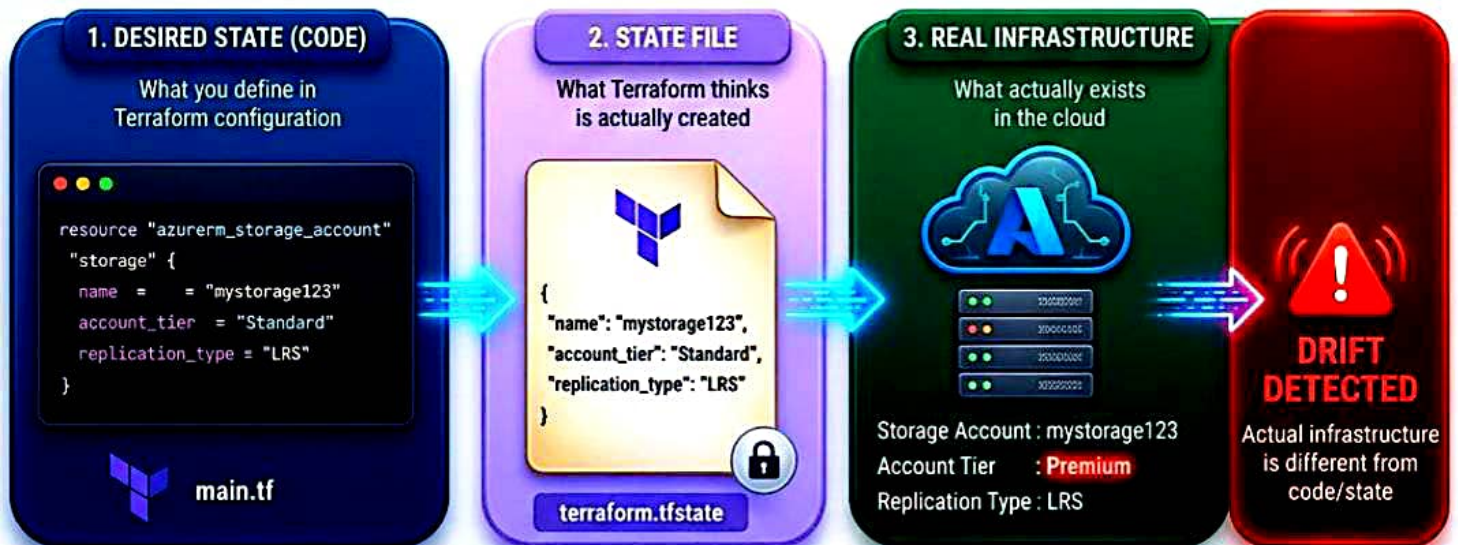
Jump Server vs Azure Bastion

Secure Access to Your Azure Resources – Which One Should You Use?

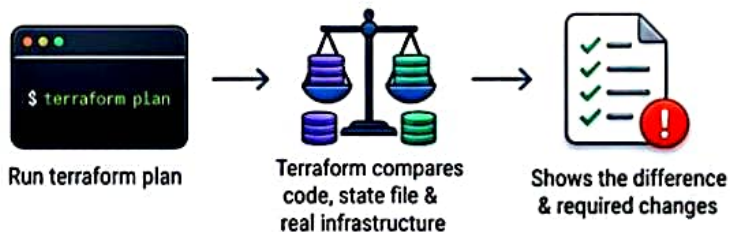


TERRAFORM DRIFT STATE

When real infrastructure is different from your code & state file



HOW TERRAFORM DETECTS DRIFT?



EXAMPLE

- You create a Storage Account using Terraform
- Someone changes the tier from Standard to Premium in Azure Portal
- Terraform code & state file are still showing Standard
- Now, Terraform detects drift

BEST PRACTICES

- Avoid manual changes in the cloud console
- Manage infrastructure only through Terraform
- Use remote state with state locking
- Run `terraform plan` before every `apply`
- Regularly review infrastructure changes



KEY TAKEAWAY: Terraform works best when it is the single source of truth for your infrastructure. Avoid manual changes to keep your infrastructure consistent, predictable & easy to manage.



AUTHENTICATION VS AUTHORIZATION

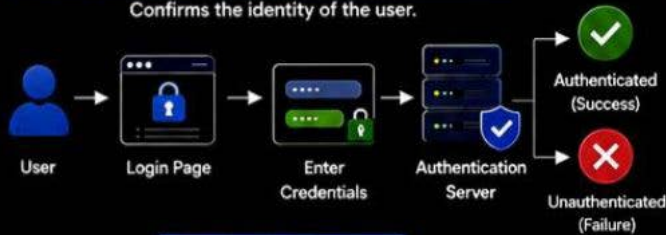
Authentication verifies **WHO** you are. Authorization determines **WHAT** you can do.



Understanding the difference between Authentication and Authorization is essential for building secure **Cloud**, **DevOps**, and **Cybersecurity** environments.

1. AUTHENTICATION (Verify WHO You Are)

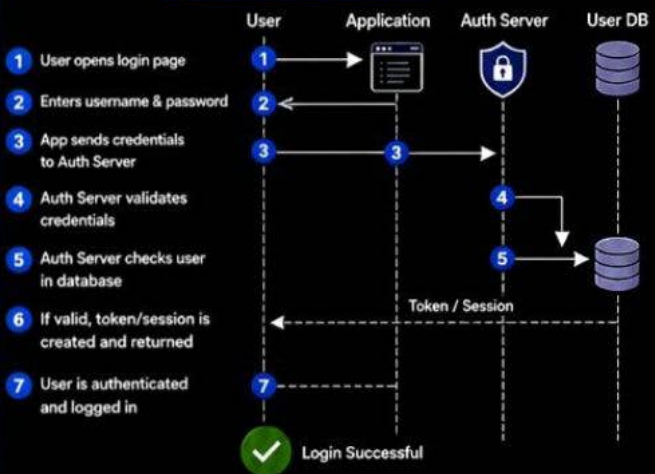
Confirms the identity of the user.



Authentication Methods

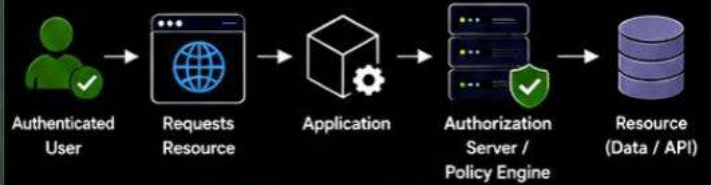


Authentication Flow (Login)



2. AUTHORIZATION (Verify WHAT You Can Do)

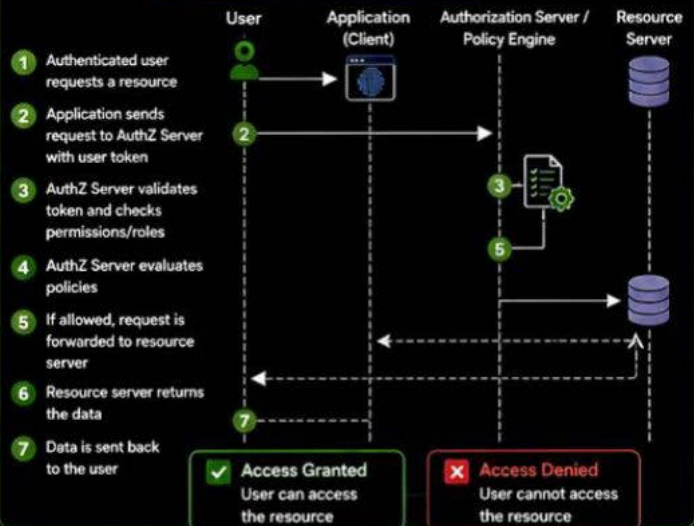
Determines what resources and actions the user is allowed to access.



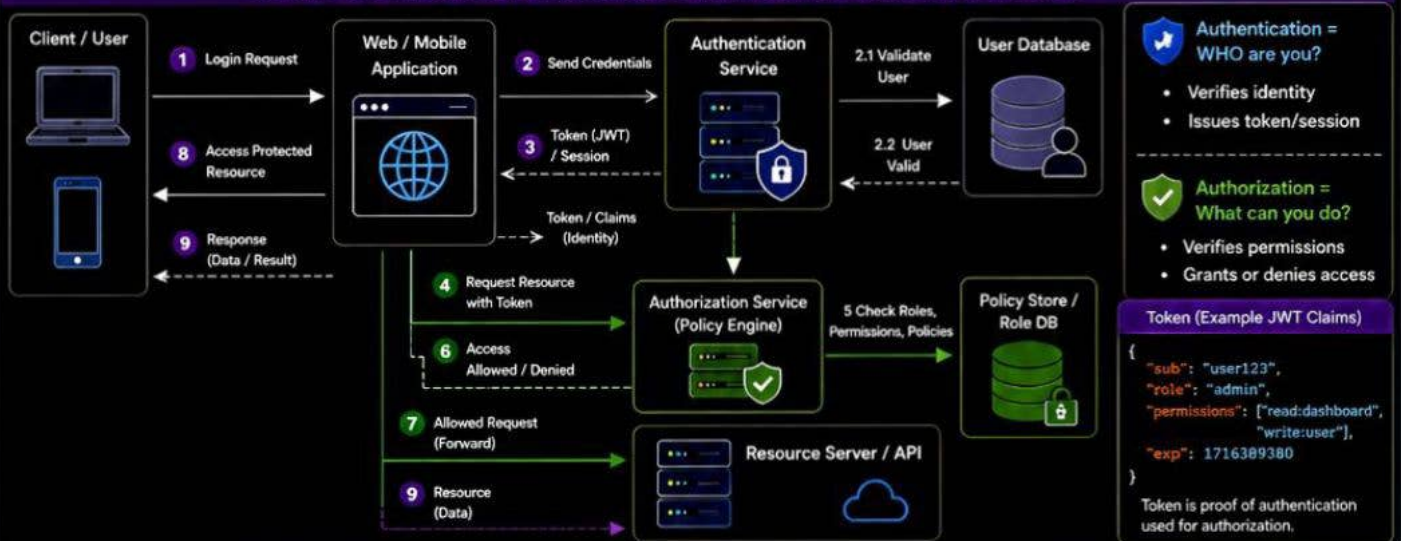
Authorization Factors



Authorization Flow (Access Control)



3. END-TO-END ARCHITECTURE: AUTHENTICATION vs AUTHORIZATION



KEY TAKEAWAY





RAG vs FINE-TUNING vs PROMPT ENGINEERING

One of the most common questions in AI:
Should I use prompting, RAG, or fine-tuning?

The answer depends on what you're trying to change.

◆ By-Aadit Gupta ◆

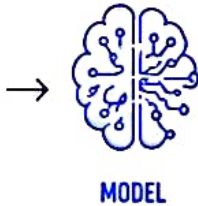
1 PROMPT ENGINEERING

Change the instructions,
not the model.

INSTRUCTIONS

You are a helpful
assistant...

Answer in bullet
points.



BEST FOR:

- ✓ Controlling behavior
- ✓ Improving output quality
- ✓ Formatting and reasoning
- ✓ Quick experimentation

USE IT WHEN

The model already has
the knowledge you need.



2 RAG

Give the model access to
external knowledge at runtime.

YOUR DATA

Documents

Web Pages

Databases



BEST FOR:

- ✓ Private or enterprise data
- ✓ Frequently changing information
- ✓ Reducing hallucinations
- ✓ Grounded answers

USE IT WHEN

The problem is mainly about
giving the model the right context.



3 FINE-TUNING

Train the model on examples
to change how it behaves.

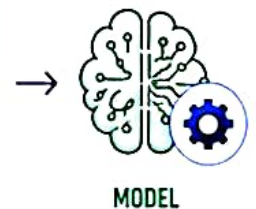
TRAINING DATA (EXAMPLES)

Example 1

Example 2

...

Example N



BEST FOR:

- ✓ Specialized behavior
- ✓ Consistent style or format
- ✓ Domain-specific tasks
- ✓ High-volume repetitive workloads

USE IT WHEN

Prompting alone isn't enough
to achieve the desired behavior.



THE SIMPLEST WAY TO REMEMBER IT:



PROMPTING

→ Change the
instructions



RAG

→ Change
the context



FINE-TUNING

→ Change the
behavior

AND THEY AREN'T
MUTUALLY EXCLUSIVE.

A production AI system
can use all three:



THE BIGGEST MISTAKE?

Fine-tuning when the real
problem is missing context.



If the model doesn't know something,
give it the right information first
(RAG / Better context).



If it knows the information but
doesn't behave the way you need,
then consider fine-tuning.



Choose the simplest approach that solves the problem.



Which approach do you
use most in your AI projects?



TERRAFORM MODULAR ARCHITECTURE



Scalable | Reusable | Maintainable | Production Ready

